

AI Adoption Checklist for African Businesses

A practical, step-by-step guide to assessing your readiness, choosing the right use cases, and successfully adopting AI and data analytics in your organisation.

1. DATA FOUNDATIONS

- ☐ Audit your current data sources and identify the biggest gaps
- ☐ Establish a single source of truth for key business metrics
- ☐ Implement basic data governance and data quality standards

2. STRATEGY & USE CASES

- ☐ Identify 2–3 high-impact, low-complexity AI use cases to start with
- ☐ Align AI initiatives with measurable business outcomes (cost, revenue, risk)
- ☐ Secure executive sponsorship before scaling beyond a pilot

3. TALENT & SKILLS

- ☐ Assess your team's current data and AI literacy
- ☐ Invest in targeted upskilling rather than hiring a full team upfront
- ☐ Partner with experienced consultants for your first 1–2 projects

4. INFRASTRUCTURE & TOOLS

- ☐ Choose cloud or on-premise infrastructure based on data residency needs
- ☐ Start with proven, well-supported tools before custom-building
- ☐ Plan for scalability from day one

5. GOVERNANCE & ETHICS

- ☐ Establish clear data privacy and security policies
- ☐ Define accountability for AI-driven decisions
- ☐ Monitor deployed models for bias and performance drift

6. CHANGE MANAGEMENT

- ☐ Communicate the "why" behind AI adoption to your whole team
- ☐ Start small, measure results, and iterate
- ☐ Celebrate and share early wins to build organisational buy-in

NEED HELP PUTTING THIS INTO PRACTICE?

DAQS helps organisations across Africa turn this checklist into a working AI roadmap — from data strategy to deployment.

Book a free consultation at daqs.com/contact.